Activity 3: Create a Slogan and Essay on Environmental Issues

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BSCS - 3

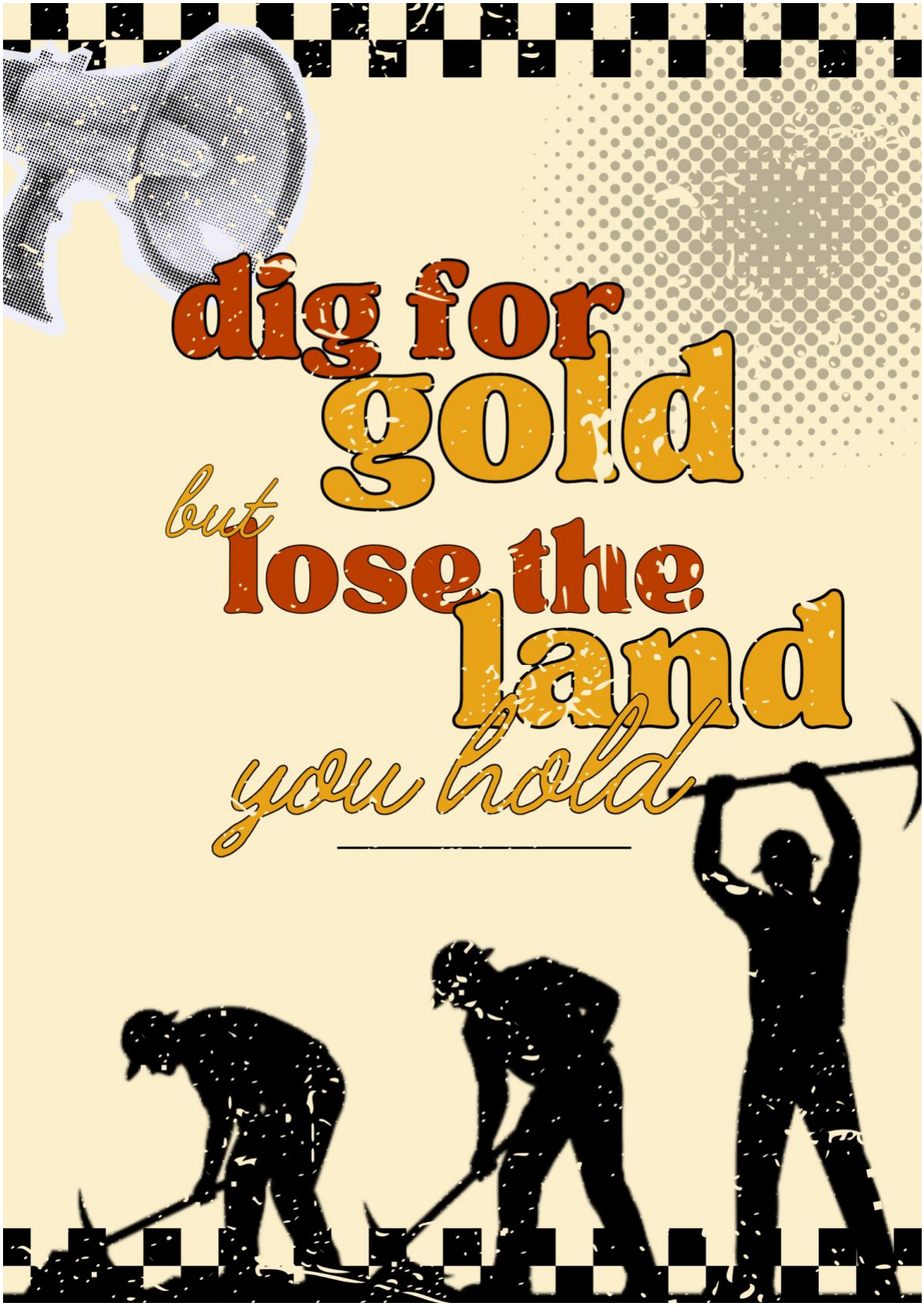
SLOGAN

“Dig for Gold, But Lose the Land You Hold.”

The slogan "Dig for Gold, But Lose the Land You Hold" speaks directly to the consequences of irresponsible mining. Literally, it describes what happens when people or corporations extract valuable minerals from the earth without regard for the damage left behind. Yes, digging may yield short-term profit, but it also strips away the very ground that communities, farmers, and ecosystems depend on. In Davao City itself, barangays like Calinan and Malagos — situated along the foothills and forested corridors of the Davao River watershed — face creeping threats from upstream mining activities. Rivers that once ran clear now carry silt and sediment; agricultural lands that sustained families for generations are increasingly threatened by contaminated runoff. The slogan captures this painful trade-off in a single, memorable line: what we gain in gold, we lose in the land beneath our feet.

Beyond its literal meaning, the slogan carries a deeper warning about greed, short-sightedness, and the illusion of progress. The word "gold" symbolizes not just mineral wealth, but also the promise of economic development that mining companies often use to justify their operations. Yet the phrase "lose the land you hold" is a powerful reminder that land is not merely a resource — it is an identity, a livelihood, and a legacy. For communities in Calinan and Malagos, the land sustains durian and banana farms, freshwater springs, and thriving biodiversity that draws ecotourism to the area. When mining encroaches on surrounding watersheds, it does not just take soil; it displaces families, contaminates water sources, and destroys ecosystems that took centuries to develop. Even in urban Obrero, where residents are farther from the mountains, the effects trickle down — literally — through the Davao River system. Murky floodwaters, declining fish catches, and water quality concerns are all downstream consequences of upstream destruction. The slogan thus challenges us to look beyond the gold and see the true cost: eroded mountains, poisoned rivers, and communities left with nothing but scars.

I chose mining as my topic because of its direct and deeply personal relevance to the Davao communities I call home. Calinan and Malagos are not just geographical names — they are places of breathtaking natural beauty, where the Davao River flows strong and the forests still breathe. Yet these barangays sit within reach of mining pressure from Davao de Oro, where the devastating 2012 landslides and floods — worsened by years of deforestation and mining — claimed hundreds of lives and serve as a grim warning of what unchecked extraction can do. As a student from Davao, I feel a responsibility to amplify this issue before the destruction reaches our doorstep. The land around us is not an infinite resource to be exploited; it is the foundation of our food, our water, and our future. I hope this slogan serves as a call to action — urging local government units, corporations, and every citizen of Davao to demand responsible and sustainable practices before more of our precious land is lost forever.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